Building 4 Our Future: Board Orientation Guide

Oct 22, 2026

Welcome. Building 4 Our Future is a new Illinois nonprofit that you are helping to build from the ground up, and it is not yet tax-exempt.

Where we stand today

- Incorporated in Illinois on January 21, 2026 (File #75444524).
- Federal EIN issued.
- No application to the IRS for 501(c)(3) status has been filed yet. The IRS can recognize the organization back to its start date if the application is filed within 27 months of incorporation, which is about April 30, 2028.
- No money has been collected and no programs have run.
- The first board steps are to amend the Articles, adopt the bylaws and conflict policy, elect officers, open a bank account and prepare the IRS application. The Organizational Board Meeting packet covers all of them.

Mission, programs and how we connect to the others

Our mission is to build financial literacy and entrepreneurship in underserved communities, starting in Chicago, and to mentor youth through education and athletics. The Year 1 plan asks for $123,200 to serve 270 participants through three programs. A youth athletics and mentoring pilot is planned for Year 2.

Building 4 Our Future is one of three organizations in the New Black Wall Street Initiative, which is the founder's overall plan:

Organization	Role	Type
Block Wall Street LLC	Builds ventures and earns the revenue that supports the plan.	For-profit LLC, separately owned
Sun School of Satoshi	Teaches Bitcoin, money and business skills.	For-profit LLC, separately owned

Organization	Role	Type
Building 4 Our Future	Carries the work to the community through grants and donations.	Nonprofit

What this means for you. Building 4 Our Future has its own board and its own money. It is not owned or controlled by the other two. Any license, service or loan between us and them must be in writing, at fair value, and approved by directors who have no stake in the other side.

Your duties as a director

The law asks three things of every director.

- **Care.** Come prepared, ask questions, and read the financial reports before you vote.
- **Loyalty.** Put the nonprofit first. Disclose any interest you have in a decision and step out of it. Do not use the organization for personal or business gain.
- **Obedience.** Keep the organization true to its stated charitable purpose and follow the law.

Independence. The board must have a majority of independent directors, meaning people who are not paid by, and are not family of anyone paid by, the organization or its related companies. Two of the first three directors have ties to related companies. Isun Jones-Boler owns Sun School of Satoshi LLC, and Tawanda Jennings is expected to own Block Wall Street LLC. They stay on the board and step out of any vote involving those companies. The board will add at least two more independent directors before it approves any agreement with either company. If you have any other tie to a related company, say so now.

Signing the conflict policy. Every director signs the Conflict of Interest Policy and the annual disclosure statement before the first vote.

Governance documents and meetings

Four documents run the organization. Read them in this order.

1. **Articles of Incorporation and the Articles of Amendment.** The filed rules: purposes, no private profit, and what happens to assets if we close.
2. **Bylaws.** How the board works day to day.

3. **Conflict of Interest Policy.** What to disclose and when to step out.
4. **Organizational meeting resolutions.** The first decisions the board adopts.

Topic	Rule in the bylaws
Board size	3 to 9 directors, majority independent
Term	Three years, staggered
Notice of meetings	5 days for a regular meeting, 2 days for a special meeting
Quorum	A majority of directors in office
Removing a director	Two-thirds vote of directors in office
Officers	President, Secretary, Treasurer, optional Vice President
Fiscal year	Calendar year
Records	Kept for 7 years, with core records kept permanently

When a bylaw and this guide differ, the bylaws control. The annual report to the Illinois Secretary of State is due before the anniversary month, around January 2027 for the first one.

Fundraising and public statements

Until the IRS recognizes the organization and the board adopts a fundraising resolution, these rules apply.

- **Do not tell anyone a gift is tax-deductible.** Say instead that the organization is incorporated in Illinois and is working toward federal tax-exempt status.
- **Do not collect money** until the board has opened a bank account in the organization's name. Never use a personal account or the account of Block Wall Street LLC or Sun School of Satoshi.
- **Register first.** Charitable solicitation in Illinois requires registration with the Attorney General's Charitable Trust Bureau, so confirm with the nonprofit attorney before any public appeal.

- **Keep money separate.** Nonprofit funds pay nonprofit costs only. Nothing moves to a related company except under a written, board-approved agreement.
- **A fiscal sponsor** (an existing 501(c)(3) that holds funds for a project) is an option for taking early grants and gifts while the application is prepared.
- **Use the right name.** Marketing for the nonprofit says Building 4 Our Future, not the name of the for-profit company.

Your first 90 days

- [ ] Read the Articles of Amendment, Bylaws and Conflict of Interest Policy.
- [ ] Sign the Conflict of Interest disclosure.
- [ ] Attend the organizational board meeting and vote on the opening resolutions.
- [ ] Confirm officers and your three-year term class.
- [ ] Review the Program Overview and the $123,200 Year 1 budget.
- [ ] Help choose a nonprofit attorney to review the filings.
- [ ] Approve the plan and timeline for the IRS application.
- [ ] Agree on the board meeting calendar for the next 12 months.
- [ ] Name one or two people you will introduce to the mission.

Reading list

- Articles of Amendment
- Bylaws
- Conflict of Interest Policy
- Organizational Board Meeting packet
- Program Overview and Funding Proposal
- Position Descriptions